Clonidine

FORM Oral solution containing clonidine 50micrograms in 5ml

INDICATION
Sedation
Pain
Opiate Withdrawal

DOSE RANGE

AGE	DOSE	FREQUENCY	ROUTE
Birth - 6 months	Initially 3micrograms/kg; increased if necessary up to 5micrograms/kg	8 hourly	Oral/NG

CAUTIONS, CONTRA-INDICATIONS AND SIDE EFFECTS
- See Summary of Product Characteristics and most recent edition of BNF for Children

FURTHER INFORMATION

- Blood pressure and pulse rate must be monitored on initiating treatment and after each dose increase
- Use with caution in renal impairment
- Oral clonidine has high bioavailability, when switching from IV therapy the total daily dose is 1:1. Total daily dose of IV treatment should be divided into three oral doses. However caution is advised with IV doses greater than 3mcg/kg/hr due to potential bradycardia and hypotension. Please discuss these situations with pharmacy prior to IVOS.
- If clonidine treatment exceeds 7 days (including IV) then dose should be weaned prior to stopping

LICENSED STATUS Unlicensed use

APPLICABLE POLICIES West of Scotland Neonatal Guidelines:

Consult local policy if applicable

Document Number:	003	Supersedes:	002
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Date prepared	September 2026	Date updated	September 2029

Dose may vary depending on indication, age, renal function, hepatic function, and concomitant medications.
This monograph should be used in conjunction with the terms of reference document prepared by the West of Scotland Pharmacist Group. Information is correct at the time of publication and as per local practice agreement.
For further advice contact your clinical pharmacist or pharmacy department.